

► GRUMMAN E-2C HAWKEYE

Date 1964 **Origin** US
Wingspan 24.56m (80½ft)
Length 17.54m (57½ft)
Top speed 602kph (374mph)
Engine Two 3,663kW (4,910hp)
 Allison T56-A-425 turboprops

The first true Airborne Early Warning (AEW) aircraft, the Hawkeye's distinctive rotating radome was able to discover and track enemy aircraft, and then direct friendly aircraft to intercept them.



▲ LOCKHEED SR-71 BLACKBIRD

Date 1966 **Origin** US
Wingspan 16.94m (55½ft)
Length 32.74m (107½ft)
Top speed 3,661kph (2,275mph)
Engine Two 14,742kg (32,500lb)
 Pratt & Whitney J58-1 turbo ramjets

A strategic reconnaissance aircraft that saw extensive operational service during the Vietnam War, the SR-71 is not only the world's fastest aircraft, it has also set the sustained altitude record of 29,929m (98,192ft).

▼ BOEING E-3A SENTRY (AWACS)

Date 1977 **Origin** US
Wingspan 44.4m (145¼ft)
Length 46.6m (153ft)
Top speed 853kph (530mph)
Engine Four 9,540kg (21,000lb) Pratt & Whitney TF33-PW-100 turbofans

The US Air Force's Airborne Warning and Control System (AWACS) is a converted Boeing 707 airliner. The rotating dish antenna can detect aircraft within a radius of 395km (245 miles). Onboard computers assess the threat and control friendly aircraft in defence.



Pratt & Whitney turbojet

▼ BOEING E-6B MERCURY

Date 1989 **Origin** US
Wingspan 45.2m (148¼ft)
Length 45.8m (150¼ft)
Top speed 970kph (600mph)
Engine Four 150kN (34,000lb) CMFI
 CFM56-2A-2 turbofans

The E-6B Mercury is the command post and communications relay designed to maintain control of America's nuclear forces if ground-based control became impossible during a nuclear war.

